

MP-105: Arthroscopic Knee Surgery

Bellcourt Medical Policy | Version 1 | Status: ACTIVE | Effective for dates of service 2024-01-01 until superseded

Field	Value
Policy number	MP-105
Service code(s)	BHA-SURG-2988
Applies to	All clients administered by Bellcourt unless the client's plan document or delegation addendum states otherwise
Owner	Clinical Policy Committee
Version	v1

1. Purpose and scope

This policy sets out the clinical criteria Bellcourt reviewers use to decide whether the service described in this policy (Arthroscopic Knee Surgery) is medically necessary. It is applied to prior authorization requests where the date of service falls within the effective period stated above. A client's plan document may exclude this service or impose additional requirements; plan provisions are checked first.

2. Definitions

Medically necessary: services that are appropriate and consistent with the diagnosis, in accordance with generally accepted standards of medical practice, and not primarily for the convenience of the member or provider.

3. Coverage criteria

The service is considered medically necessary when the criteria below are met, read together using the AND / OR connectors shown:

- 1 Mechanical symptoms (locking, catching, or giving way); AND
- 2 A meniscal tear or loose body confirmed on MRI; AND
- 3 Failure of at least 6 weeks of conservative therapy; AND
- 4 Absence of advanced osteoarthritis (Kellgren-Lawrence grade 3 or 4).

4. Not medically necessary / limitations

- Arthroscopic debridement or lavage for osteoarthritis.
- Any arthroscopy in a knee with Kellgren-Lawrence grade 3 or 4 osteoarthritis.

5. Documentation requirements

Knee exam, MRI report, weight-bearing radiographs with Kellgren-Lawrence grade, conservative therapy record.

If required documentation is missing, the request must be pended and the provider contacted for information. It must not be denied for lack of documentation until the information request has gone unanswered within the regulatory timeframe.

6. Version history

Version	Effective	Summary
v1	2024-01-01	Initial version.